

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

MARIAN ‘CINDY’ PRITZKER 1923-2025

Family matriarch made mark on city

Cindy Pritzker answers questions about the Millennium Park project with Mayor Richard M. Daley behind her in 1999. The Pritzker family matriarch died Saturday at 101. **NANCY STONE/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**



Philanthropist, governor’s aunt was mainstay in Chicago’s civic community

By Bob Goldsborough
Chicago Tribune

For decades, Marian “Cindy” Pritzker, the matriarch of one of Chicago’s wealthiest and best-known families, was a mainstay in Chicago’s philanthropic, cultural and civic communities.

Like her late husband, Jay, who built the Hyatt Hotels chain, Pritzker was an architecture aficionado who played a role in the creation of several cultural touchstones in Chicago, among them the Jay Pritzker Pavilion at Millennium

Park, which was designed by noted architect Frank Gehry, and the Harold Washington Library Center in the Loop, which came to fruition while she headed the Chicago Public Library Board.

Pritzker, who was 101, died Saturday, according to a family spokesperson. She was Gov. JB Pritzker’s aunt and had homes in the Streeterville neighborhood and Rancho Santa Fe, California.

Born Marian Friend in Chicago in 1923 to Cook County Judge Hugo Friend and Sadie Cohen Friend, Pritzker was the grand-

daughter of Jewish immigrants from Eastern Europe. Two years before Pritzker was born, her father was assigned to preside over the notorious Chicago “Black Sox” trial, in which eight former White Sox players were indicted — but ultimately acquitted — on charges of throwing the 1919 World Series. The players were banned from baseball.

Pritzker grew up in the South Side’s Kenwood neighborhood. “I had the time of my life,” she

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Courts facing escalation of attacks

Judiciary targeted as Trump overhaul loses some rulings

By Nicholas Riccardi
Associated Press

The new populist president railed against the judiciary as they blocked his aggressive moves to restructure his country’s government and economy.

This was in Mexico, where former President Andrés Manuel López Obrador eventually pushed through changes that required every judge in his country to be elected rather than appointed. The reforms, and the promise of more by his successor, caused markets to lose confidence in his country’s reliability as a place to invest, which led its currency to weaken.

It was one in a series of assaults that populists around the globe have launched on the courts in recent years, and legal observers now wonder if the United States could be next.

As the courts deliver setbacks to his attempt to change the federal government with no congressional approval, President Donald Trump’s supporters are echoing some of the rhetoric and actions that elsewhere have preceded attacks on the judiciary.

Trump’s deputy chief of staff, Stephen Miller, posted last week on X: “Under the precedents now being established by radical rogue judges, a district court in Hawaii could enjoin troop movements in Iraq. Judges have no authority to administer the executive branch.

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Illini draw No. 6 seed in NCAA tourney

The Illini earned the No. 6 seed in the Midwest Region and will play a first-round game Friday in Milwaukee, putting them in reasonable driving distance from Chicago or Champaign. **Chicago Sports**

Blige in top vocal form in hurried show

Singer-songwriter Mary J. Blige’s 100-minute set at United Center was hindered by questionable pacing and condensed arrangements that minimized her formidable skills as a vocalist. **Arts & Living**

Death toll from storms rises to 37

Residents pounded by unusually vicious weather across parts of the country surveyed damage Sunday from tornadoes, high winds and dust storms that decimated homes and other structures — and left at least 37 dead. **Nation & World**



EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Marching into St. Patrick’s Day

Irish dancers march south on Western Avenue in the South Side Irish Parade in Beverly and Morgan Park in Chicago on Sunday. Parade committee officials estimated a turnout of 77,000. The event featured more than 100 entries and floats in its 45th year. **Chicagoland, Page 3**



Teacher Heather Debby collects cellphones in a classroom on Thursday at Disney II Magnet School in Chicago. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Pritzker wants phones out of the classroom. Not everyone agrees

Advocates of ban cite distractions, opponents worry about security

By Addison Wright and Molly Morrow
Chicago Tribune

SPRINGFIELD — Jill Friday said her Spanish language classrooms at Southeast High School in Springfield last year often felt like student living rooms, with kids scrolling on their phones, taking calls from family members and listening to music on headphones.

After weeks of tripping on phone chargers snaking around chairs, Friday enlisted a school janitor to plug up all the charging outlets. Students still snuck to the halls to charge their phones and answer family calls.

Those problems ended, for the most part, last August, when the Springfield school district enacted new rules requiring high schoolers to

have their phones off and put away during class, middle schoolers to keep their phones in their lockers and elementary schoolers to keep them in their bags. Previously, each school could write its own policy.

The district’s phone policy update was a relief for Friday.

“In the past, kids would just sit there passively because

Turn to Phones, Page 2

Johnson boosts Black community outreach

‘The Re-reconstruction’: Mayor doubles down on delivering message

By Alice Yin and Jake Sheridan
Chicago Tribune

On New Year’s Day, Mayor Brandon Johnson welcomed 2025 by reminding Chicago leaders of the headwinds Black politicians like him face.

The mayor sent a Crusader piece from last October titled, “Are Black mayors under attack across the U.S., some say it’s a pattern,” to his business liaison Charles Smith, according to copies of Johnson’s texts obtained by the Tribune through a public records request.

“Happy New Year!” Johnson wrote to Smith, who replied: “Crusader poppin out!”

Johnson also messaged the article to state Rep. Kam Buckner and Service Employees International Union Healthcare Illinois President Greg Kelley: “Thought this was an interesting read.” In other January texts, the mayor told political allies the city was undergoing a new Reconstruction era, an allusion to the period of rapid but ultimately halted Black advancement after the Civil War.

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